

ZHAOJING YANG

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Meta Superintelligence Labs (MSL)

Research Engineer

May 2026 - Present

Assured Robot Intelligence (ARI)

Founding Research Engineer

May 2025 - May 2026

Acquired by Meta

EDUCATION

University of Southern California

M.S. in Computer Science

Aug 2022 - May 2024

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

B.Eng. in Computer Science

Sep 2018 - Jun 2022

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on **Robot Learning**, especially learning generalizable policies that can be deployed in the real world. My goal is to build robots that carry out complex real-world tasks and understand human instructions, enabling better human-robot collaboration.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Legged Robot Locomotion with Reinforcement Learning

Visiting Researcher, UCSD

Jun 2024 - May 2025

Advisor: Xiaolong Wang

- Trained an obstacle-avoiding locomotion policy with RL in IsaacLab, using LiDAR as exteroceptive input and a single-stage training pipeline.
- Deployed the policy on a Unitree Go2 quadruped and integrated it with NaVILA, a vision-language-action (VLA) model for navigation.
- Built a navigation benchmark in IsaacLab to evaluate the full system end to end.

Preference-based Learning with Human Language Feedback

Research Assistant, USC

Aug 2023 - Jun 2024

Advisor: Erdem Biyik

- Proposed a framework that learns a shared latent space between robot trajectories and comparative language feedback, which is then used to learn human reward functions and improve robot trajectories.
- Ran real-robot user studies in which our approach scored 23.9% higher in subjective ratings on average and was 11.3% more time-efficient than the baseline.

Multi-drones Collision Avoidance with Reinforcement Learning

Research Assistant, USC

Nov 2022 - Jun 2023

Advisor: Gaurav Sukhatme

- Proposed an end-to-end RL policy that outputs direct thrust commands for quadrotors, reaching a 97% success rate in obstacle and neighbor avoidance in simulation.
- Added an attention module to the policy and deployed it on real Crazyflie micro-quadrotors.

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] **Grounded 3D-Aware Spatial Vision-Language Modeling**
An-Chieh Cheng, Yang Fu, Yatai Ji, Ligeng Zhu, Guanqi Zhan, Zhuoyang Zhang, **Zhaojing Yang**, Song Han, Yao Lu, Pavlo Molchanov, Vidya Nariyambut Murali, Jan Kautz, Xiaolong Wang, Hongxu Yin, Sifei Liu
arXiv preprint, 2026 [[paper](#)]
- [2] **When a Robot is More Capable than a Human: Learning from Constrained Demonstrators**
Xinhu Li, Ayush Jain, **Zhaojing Yang**, Yigit Korkmaz, Erdem Biyik
ICLR 2026 [[website](#), [paper](#)]
- [3] **Active Reward Learning and Iterative Trajectory Improvement from Comparative Language Feedback**
Eisuke Hirota*, **Zhaojing Yang***, Ayano Hiranaka, Miru Jun, Jeremy Tien, Stuart J. Russell, Anca Dragan, Erdem Biyik
IJRR 2026 [[website](#), [code](#)]

- [4] **Real Deep Research for AI, Robotics and Beyond**
Xueyan Zou, Jianglong Ye, Hao Zhang, Xiaoyu Xiang, Mingyu Ding, **Zhaojing Yang**, Yong Jae Lee, Zhuowen Tu, Sifei Liu, Xiaolong Wang
arXiv preprint, 2025 [[paper](#)]
- [5] **NaVILA: Legged Robot Vision-Language-Action Model for Navigation**
An-Chieh Cheng*, Yandong Ji*, **Zhaojing Yang***, Zaitian Gongye, Xueyan Zou, Jan Kautz, Erdem Bıyık, Hongxu Yin[†], Sifei Liu[†], Xiaolong Wang[†]
RSS 2025 [[website](#), [paper](#), [code](#), [benchmark](#)]
- [6] **Trajectory Improvement and Reward Learning from Comparative Language Feedback**
Zhaojing Yang, Miru Jun, Jeremy Tien, Stuart J. Russell, Anca Dragan, Erdem Bıyık
CoRL 2024 [[website](#), [paper](#), [code](#)]
HRI 2024 Human-Interactive Robot Learning Workshop
- [7] **Collision Avoidance and Navigation for a Quadrotor Swarm Using End-to-end Deep Reinforcement Learning**
Zhehui Huang*, **Zhaojing Yang***, Rahul Krupani, Baskın Şenbaşlar, Sumeet Batra, Gaurav S. Sukhatme
ICRA 2024 [[website](#), [paper](#), [code](#)]
- [8] **QuadSwarm: A Modular Multi-Quadrotor Simulator for Deep Reinforcement Learning with Direct Thrust Control**
Zhehui Huang, Sumeet Batra, Tao Chen, Rahul Krupani, Tushar Kumar, Artem Molchanov, Aleksei Petrenko, James A. Preiss, **Zhaojing Yang**, Gaurav S. Sukhatme
ICRA 2023 *The Role of Robotics Simulators for Unmanned Aerial Vehicles Workshop* [[paper](#), [code](#)]

AWARDS

Zhiyuan Honor Scholarship (Top 5%)	SJTU, 2021
Undergraduate Academic Excellence Scholarship (Top 10%)	SJTU, 2019

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, C++, Shell

Robotics: ROS, IsaacLab, IsaacGym